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Gender and 1960s Youth Culture: The Rolling Stones and the New Woman

Andrew August

In the 1960s some young British women challenged established gender roles, pursuing education, careers and personal freedom. Many of them grew frustrated with the limitations of 1960s youth culture, and particularly of new permissive sexual norms. The Rolling Stones, as a significant cultural force and symbol of London youth culture and sexual 'freedom', became a focus for criticism of this culture growing out of the women's liberation movement at the end of the decade and developing in the years since then. However, the Rolling Stones' response to changing gender roles in this period was complex and contradictory. At times, their songs endorsed women's subordination, rejecting their claims to independence. On the other hand, a number of the songs celebrated independent women and mutual relationships. The Rolling Stones, central figures in the youth culture of the 1960s and a symbol of that culture's commitment to subordinating women, were conflicted and ambivalent, rather than uniformly hostile, to changing gender roles.

Keywords: Rolling Stones; Youth Culture; 1960s; Gender Roles

Feminist and historian Sheila Rowbotham grew up in Yorkshire and was 16 when the 1960s began. She rejected the constraints placed on young women in post-war Britain, later describing herself as disposed 'towards an absolute repudiation of the values of home and school'.¹ She recalls: 'all my friends wanted to find another way of being'.² After an adventuresome trip to France and study at Oxford, Rowbotham's quest took her, like many others, to London. There she embraced London's youth culture,

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'swinging' fashions, the countercultural underground, and particularly left-wing politics. Rowbotham immersed herself in anti-war protests, street theatre, the International Socialists and *Black Dwarf*, all the while working on a Ph.D. and supporting herself by teaching.

By the end of the 1960s, however, Rowbotham's increasing frustration with women's position led her into early women's liberation activities. In April 1969, she visited one of the first women's consciousness-raising groups, in Tufnell Park, and was soon hosting a growing group in her home. As her involvement in women's liberation deepened, Rowbotham became alienated from the student left and resigned from the International Socialists and *Black Dwarf*. In *Woman's Consciousness, Man's World*, published in 1973, she observes: 'the culture which was presented as "revolutionary" was so blatantly phallic'.³

Rock music influenced Rowbotham's early embrace of freedom and pursuit of authenticity. She recalls: 'the music went straight to your cunt and hit the bottom of your spine'. Even at age 16, though, she developed a critical view of popular music lyrics: 'I remember feeling really angry about "Living Doll" [a Cliff Richard song from 1959] because it... cut away from all my inside efforts towards any identity'. Written more than a decade later, *Woman's Consciousness, Man's World* offers analysis of major figures in 1960s music. Rowbotham observes that Bob Dylan and the Rolling Stones 'were often more explicitly nasty [than the Beatles]'. She continues: 'Part of them wants really to crush the new ways in which women behave, both in bed and outside'. Though Rowbotham notes 'the other part' of these songwriters that 'goes out to women', her criticism of the Rolling Stones struck a note consistent with a broad consensus of early feminist criticism and later studies of images of women in Rolling Stones songs.⁴

Many young women of Rowbotham's generation challenged 1950s gender roles. They pursued education, career, sexual freedom and a desire for autonomy by embracing the new urban youth culture. By the middle of the 1960s, popular music had become the most significant force in this culture. As historian Mark Donnelly notes, 'The most important field of all, in terms of how it allowed young people to shape their own environment, was pop music'.⁵ As women's liberation gathered steam at the end of the decade, critics influenced by the new ideas began to argue that popular music reinforced the subordination of women. More recent critics and scholars agree that popular music in the 1960s and 1970s was deeply hostile to women.⁶ The Rolling Stones, according to these observers, offer a relentless series of images of women subordinated and objectified. Although some Rolling Stones songs do fit this description, others from the same period offer a different view, celebrating independent and autonomous women and describing mutual relationships between the sexes.

In analyzing the cultural impact of popular music, a number of different approaches are useful. The music itself, the performance and the context or event in which the music is performed all shape its meaning.⁷ Words remain, however, a crucial vehicle through which popular music influences audiences. As Simon Frith notes: 'access to songs is primarily through their words... lyrics give songs their social use'.⁸ A study of the lyrics of Rolling Stones songs, from their earliest original compositions through

the mid-1970s when they were no longer a leading force in popular music, reveals a complex picture. At the same time that the band produced songs rejecting women's autonomy and celebrating their subordination, they created others endorsing and appreciating free independent women. Though they have been identified as a major cultural force rejecting women's emancipation, the Rolling Stones were ambivalent in confronting the new roles of women in youth culture of the 1960s and 1970s.

Redefining Gender Roles in the 1960s and 1970s

Though post-war British culture remained deeply patriarchal, women who came of age in the 1960s enjoyed unprecedented opportunities. The market for young women's labour shifted dramatically following World War II. Domestic service, long the dominant form of employment for young working-class women, declined precipitously. In its stead, clerical work expanded, and in 1964, nearly 40 per cent of girls aged 15–17 took clerical jobs. Young women still earned less than their male peers, but most had discretionary spending money, and newly defined 'teenaged' girls became an important segment of the market for consumer goods.⁹ Educational opportunities expanded as well. The 1944 Education Act opened free places in grammar schools for all qualified students, though class distinctions remained strong.¹⁰ Girls benefited from this access and from the expansion of higher education. The proportion of young people in Britain entering higher education increased more than threefold between 1938 and 1962. At the latter date, 30 per cent of students in higher education were women.¹¹ Finally, the 'permissive moment' began in the late 1950s. New legislation reduced government controls over sexuality and abortion, oral contraceptives entered the market and gradually became available to young women, and more open attitudes towards sexual expression spread throughout the culture.¹² Though in many ways the permissive culture of the 1960s did not live up to its emancipatory promise, it appeared to many as a vehicle for liberation.¹³

It would be easy to exaggerate the extent of these changes. Powerful constraints continued to limit women's choices and opportunities, and women who challenged gender roles and defied conventions remained a minority. In 1976, as her 30th birthday loomed, Mary Ingham interviewed women who had been in her year at grammar school. She found that most had settled into conventional roles, focused on domesticity and motherhood: 'Few of them had moved far, either psychologically or physically, from where they grew up'.¹⁴ Most young women did not cast aside traditional sexual mores. The age at first marriage for women declined from 24.6 in 1951 to 22.6 in 1971. A study in the latter year found that two-thirds of married women claimed to be virgins at the time of their marriage, and another quarter reported having sex before marriage only with their eventual spouse. Radically new patterns of sexual behaviour were, according to Jane Lewis, 'in all probability confined to a relatively small urban and largely college-educated group'.¹⁵

Some of these young city dwellers, though, challenged the limitations that British culture placed on them. For example, in an interview published in 1965, Pauline Boty,

an artist and sometimes actress, reflected: 'there are certain conventions that of course I'm not bound by that my father tried to vaguely impose . . . He didn't even want me to work when I left school'. Author Ann Quin observed in a 1965 interview, 'women, they've been so bogged down until recently—and now they're just realizing the possibilities that they have, because they've been so much the slaves of men'.¹⁶ Feminist and author Sara Maitland recalls of young women in the 1960s: 'We were undeniably greedy, both for personal experience and for instant transformation'.¹⁷ Many women sought this transformation through the dynamic youth culture thriving in London from the middle of the 1960s.

A set of strands intertwined to form this new subculture. In boutiques, galleries and clubs, fashion and enthusiastic consumerism helped define the 'style-obsessed, hedonistic and apolitical' scene of 'swinging London'.¹⁸ The countercultural underground spawned an enthusiastic drug culture and iconoclastic papers such as *Oz* and *IT*. Political activists on the left created a blizzard of splintering political organizations and spurred the anti-Vietnam protests that reached their peak at Hyde Park in October 1968. Many young people in London 'had their lives transformed by new experiences, opportunities and freedoms'.¹⁹ Libertine attitudes towards sexuality pervaded this youth culture, as Marcus Collins notes: 'Mixing of the most uninhibited kind was one of the hallmarks of the underground'.²⁰

By the mid-1960s, images of young women breaking out of traditional restrictions, seeking independence and sexual freedom, and challenging male dominance grew common in British culture. One such woman was the fashion designer Mary Quant, celebrated for her liberating clothes and unrestrained lifestyle. Quant opened her first boutique in 1955 and had become a celebrity by the early 1960s. One of her designs, worn by model Jean Shrimpton, was featured on the cover of the first edition of the *Sunday Times Magazine* in 1962.²¹ The *Daily Express* praised her creations: 'Comfortable, simple, no waists, good colors and simple fabrics. It gave anyone wearing them a sense of identity with youth and adventure and brightness'.²² Quant herself revelled in the spotlight. In 1966, she was awarded the Order of the British Empire and published an autobiography, *Quant by Quant*. She loved tossing off provocative quotes. For example, she asserted that the birth control pill had given women the advantage, putting them 'in charge . . . She's standing there defiantly with her legs apart, saying, "I'm very sexy . . . but you're going to have a job to get me. You've got to excite me"'.²³ No doubt charting new territory for the OBE, she revealed in 1969 that her pubic hair was shaved into the shape of a heart.²⁴ According to Quant, women in the 1960s 'conform to their own set of values but not to the values and standards laid down by a past generation'.²⁵

In the 1965 film *Darling*, Julie Christie (who won an Academy Award for her work on the film) portrayed a young woman who rejected family life, defied constraints on sexuality and ambitiously pursued her career. Christie recalled the character as 'a woman who would actually go out and pursue her own goal . . . who didn't want to get married, didn't want to have children like those other kitchen-sink heroines; no, Darling wanted to have *everything*'.²⁶ Diana (the *Darling* of the title) exemplifies

'swinging London' in her fashionable attire, spontaneity and pursuit of sexual adventure. The film's attitude towards its main character is, however, highly critical. Diana is superficial, greedy, self-absorbed and self-pitying. The film disapproves of her and her way of life, and in the end she is punished, rejected by a lover and unhappy. Though her lifestyle is condemned in the film, Diana projects glamour and self-confidence, not least because of Julie Christie's star status. As Christine Geraghty notes, in *Darling* 'feminine discourses of beauty and fashion are not the property of the Establishment but a way of claiming a feminine identity which can be used as a mode of self-expression, particularly around sexuality'.²⁷

As young men participating in London youth culture, the Rolling Stones experienced the new woman first hand. Marianne Faithfull and Anita Pallenberg, the two women most intimately involved with songwriters Mick Jagger and Keith Richards, had independent careers before becoming consorts of the Stones. When she and Jagger became lovers, Faithfull's pop career provided 'my own place and my own life and until much later my own money'.²⁸ While involved with Jagger, she acted in films and on stage. One observer notes rather patronizingly: Faithfull had 'an independent spirit, mind and (more or less) career'.²⁹ Pallenberg was a successful model when she began seeing Stones guitarist Brian Jones. She also took up acting, even though Jones 'didn't like the fact that I was working'. After leaving Jones for bandmate Richards, Pallenberg continued her work in film, even though 'Keith had the same problem as Brian with doing the movies'.³⁰ Both had sex with others while they were seeing the Stones.³¹ One Stones biographer describes the band in this period as 'inspired by the formidable women around them'.³²

By the end of the decade, the promise of metropolitan youth culture and its permissive sexual practices began to fade for many women. Karen Moller, a fashion designer involved in the London counterculture, recalls this disillusionment: 'The alternative society pretended to be more equal, but . . . women were still doing the back-up jobs, the menial jobs and not getting any credit for it'.³³ Women began sharing their frustrations in small groups, and in 1970 hundreds gathered at Oxford for the first national women's liberation meeting.³⁴ Even before the Oxford meeting, though, women began to develop a critique of many of the assumptions and practices of the 1960s culture. In a 1966 *New Left Review* article, Juliet Mitchell analyzes a range of factors enforcing women's subordination including family structures and workforce patterns. In the context of these structures, sexual liberalization 'could presage new forms of oppression'.³⁵ In a 1969 article, Rowbotham questions women's attempts to 'prove that we have control, that we are liberated simply by fucking', adding that she and other women 'could be expressing in our sex life the very essence of our secondariness'.³⁶ By the early 1970s, this new feminist discourse on sexuality had developed a broad critique of permissiveness and the sexual objectification of women.³⁷ According to American feminist Dana Densmore, women were defined by their sexuality and expected to have sex indiscriminately. She derides sexual freedom 'that includes no freedom to decline sex, to decline to be defined at every turn by sex'.³⁸

Women in the Songs of the Rolling Stones

In 1964, a year before the release of *Darling* and two years after Jean Shrimpton appeared in a Mary Quant dress on the cover of the *Sunday Times Magazine*, the Rolling Stones released their first album. The group had already established itself through raucous concerts and successful singles, primarily covers of American rhythm and blues and rock and roll songs. The album, which included 'Tell Me', the first Rolling Stones release written by the team of Jagger and Richards, quickly reached the top of the English charts.³⁹ The Stones' popularity soared, rivalling that of the Beatles,⁴⁰ and the band relied increasingly on songs written by Jagger/Richards. During the rest of the 1960s and through the middle of the 1970s, the group remained a powerful cultural force, the 'archetypal rock group'.⁴¹ Though record sales remained strong and huge tours earned the band massive profits well beyond the end of the 1970s, by the latter years of that decade new trends, particularly punk, cast the Rolling Stones from the epicentre of cultural influence. For more than a decade, though, 'their importance and reputation in the rock world was instrumental in setting up themes of cultural meanings'.⁴² Simon Reynolds and Joy Press agree that the Stones were 'the quintessence of rock'.⁴³

The Rolling Stones experienced their first success just as London youth culture began to thrive. Their front men, Mick Jagger, Keith Richards and Brian Jones (before his death in 1969), participated in the overlapping circles of swinging, underground and even political London subcultures. Jones embraced the cutting-edge fashions of London boutiques most enthusiastically, and he welcomed the photographers who chronicled his new look. Robert Fraser, proprietor of a key fashionable London gallery, was a close friend of the Stones (and was arrested alongside Jagger and Richards at Richards' country home in 1967). Jagger served as best man at celebrity fashion photographer David Bailey's 1965 wedding to Catherine Deneuve.⁴⁴ Jagger and Richards were also friends with Jim Haynes, a key figure in the counterculture institutions *IT* and the Arts Lab.⁴⁵ Jagger's connections with Tariq Ali, among the leaders of London's student left, led to the singer's participation in the 1968 march on the American embassy in Grosvenor Square that ended in a violent confrontation with police. A few months later, when Ali formed a new radical paper, *Black Dwarf*, Jagger submitted a manuscript of the song 'Street Fightin' Man'.⁴⁶ Though their celebrity marked them off from most young people in London, the Stones, even more than the Beatles, 'were the essence of the spirit of mid-sixties London'.⁴⁷

The Stones were not only a part of this youth culture, but they also exerted a massive influence on it. In a 1969 *Oz* article critical of the Stones' lack of revolutionary purity, Germaine Greer concedes 'the Stones helped thousands of kids to bust out'.⁴⁸ Rock music awakened a desire for independence and sexual freedom in many young women. For a 16-year-old London girl in the 1960s, attending a forbidden Rolling Stones performance created the 'sense that we were going to do things *our* way, and . . . [we] rejected not just our individual parents but what their values represented socially'.⁴⁹ Young women at the Stones' concerts throughout the decade expressed

pent-up emotions. Jack Nitzsche, who collaborated with the Stones on a number of projects, recalls a 1964 concert during their second US tour. The group followed James Brown on stage: 'People were standing and screaming for James... Then the Stones came out and all the girls started crying. It was a whole new emotion'.⁵⁰ An *IT* review of a Stones concert in 1971 complains of the lack of riot and frenzy at the concert, but it does note that 'the tightly packed mass of chickies in the front of the audience squealed and sighed in all the correct places ("take me back to '65")'.⁵¹

The Stones were important symbols for their young audience. They represented the style, glamour and decadence of mid-1960s London: 'They wore the clothes, walked the walk and talked the talk'. Following Jagger and Richards' arrest on drug charges in 1967, they became the most prominent victims of the establishment's efforts to crack down on the counterculture and its drug use. After their conviction, a huge crowd of 'freaks' marched from the club UFO on the offices of *News of the World*, the tabloid widely believed to have set up the Stones.⁵² Perhaps above all, the Stones represented sexual permissiveness. The most notorious aspect of the 1967 drug bust at Richards' country estate was the presence of Marianne Faithfull wrapped only in a rug, which, according to Malcolm Morris QC, 'from time to time, she allowed to fall, disclosing her nude body'. A rumour quickly spread that the police found Faithfull and Jagger engaged in sexual activity involving a Mars bar.⁵³ The songs themselves, modelled on American blues, embraced and expressed sexuality.⁵⁴ John D. Wells notes: 'Young persons were drawn to [the Stones'] public expressions of sex which was rebellion because these desires were supposed to be private sensations'.⁵⁵

By the 1970s, the context for the Stones' music had changed, yet their songs continued to present diverse images of women. The creative and dynamic cultural ferment of 1960s London faded. Brian Jones descended into drugs and instability and died in 1969. Faced with large unpaid tax bills, the Stones (including new guitarist Mick Taylor) moved into tax exile that lasted from spring 1971 to the end of 1972.⁵⁶ The music itself also changed across the first decade of Jagger/Richards song writing. Their early pop efforts rapidly gave way to a more mature rock sound, as seen in the explosive hit '(I Can't Get No) Satisfaction' from 1965. In 1967, though, the Stones took a detour into psychedelia, releasing the album *Their Satanic Majesties Request*. A year later, the group returned to a stripped-down rock style, and they produced a series of acclaimed rock albums culminating in *Exile on Main Street* in 1972. The middle of the 1970s saw more eclectic records and experimentation with Caribbean and other styles. Lyrical styles varied along with the music, but, as Sheila Whiteley notes, in the approach to women and sexuality in their songs, 'There is, then, no real sense of change'.⁵⁷

As many women grew sceptical of sexual permissiveness at the end of the 1960s, popular music, and the Rolling Stones in particular, attracted criticism. In a 1971 *New York Times* article, Marion Meade observes: 'Rock music, in fact the entire rock "culture," is tremendously degrading to women'. The Rolling Stones, she continues, exemplify the most disturbing trends in this culture: 'The worst picture of women appears in the music of the Rolling Stones, where sexual exploitation reaches unique

heights'.⁵⁸ These early analyses emphasize Stones songs from 1966 that advocate the subordination of women, and they cite the sexual objectification of women in Jagger/Richards compositions. In the 1970s, feminists focused on combating rape and violence against women, and critics noted the violence in Rolling Stones songs. In the following decades, as feminist scholarship and the study of popular culture developed, a number of studies have extended the original critiques of the Rolling Stones in new directions. These analyses, though, reinforce the consensus that the Rolling Stones are, 'one of the most misogynistic groups ever'.⁵⁹

There is good reason for this criticism. The Stones produced songs that endorse the subordination of women, depict them as objects for sexual conquest and present images of violence against women. However, a more detailed study of Rolling Stones songs from this period reveals that, while they did advocate the subordination of women in some songs, in others they sang about free and independent women in positive ways, offering models of new women who challenge traditional restrictions and reject male control. They also depict complex and sympathetic relationships between equal partners. Though analyses of popular music in general and of the Rolling Stones in particular claim that they exemplified and reinforced the culture's hostility towards women, a careful analysis of Rolling Stones songs reveals a complex and contradictory response to the new woman of the 1960s. Coming to prominence amidst the upheaval in gender roles of the 1960s, the Rolling Stones responded equivocally, at times seeking to reinforce women's subordination and at times embracing a model of women's independence and mutuality between the sexes.

In 1966, the band's first album comprised entirely of Jagger/Richards compositions, *Aftermath*, appeared. A 1972 article in the American feminist newspaper *Off Our Backs* focused on songs from the album that reveal 'a contempt for women which is never rejected, but rather reinforced in their later music'.⁶⁰ In 'Under My Thumb', the narrator celebrates the subordination of a woman who 'once had me down'. The woman had pushed him around, but now she 'does just what she's told'. The sexual double standard is reasserted, as the narrator can look at others while the woman keeps her eyes to herself. Susan Hiwatt's 1970 analysis of 'Cock Rock' calls 'Under My Thumb' 'a revenge song filled with hatred for women'.⁶¹ While 'Under My Thumb' represents the Stones' most blatant embrace of patriarchy, other songs released or recorded in 1966 echo its hostility towards women. In 'Stupid Girl', the listener is urged to gaze at a girl ridiculed as 'the worst thing in this world', and 'the sickest thing in this world'. In 'Yesterday's Papers', recorded later in 1966 and released on the album *Between the Buttons* early in 1967, a former girlfriend is discarded and demeaned. 'Who wants yesterday's papers?/Who wants yesterday's girl?/Who wants yesterday's papers?/Nobody in the world'. As the band's bassist Bill Wyman recalls, these songs 'branded Mick and Keith as anti-feminist writers making no bones of their taste for male domination and female submission'.⁶²

Early criticism also cites images of women as sexual objects in Rolling Stones songs. Pedigo notes: 'it is clear the Stones accept the premise that the definition of Woman is derived solely from her sexual, or lack of, relationship to man'.⁶³ The narrator

of 'Parachute Woman' (1968) urges a woman to 'land on me tonight' and 'blow me out'. He brags 'my heavy throbbler's itchin', 'and boasts that he'll 'get hot again in half the time'. In 'Stray Cat Blues', also from 1968, the narrator invites a 15-year-old girl to join him upstairs, noting 'it's no capital crime'. Hearing of the girl's 'wilder' friend, the narrator suggests that the friend come upstairs as well, 'if she's so wild then she can join in too.' The narrator of 'If You Can't Rock Me' (1974) scans an audience of women in leather and lace, as he's 'just dying for some spills and thrills.' Noting 'a thousand lips I would love to taste', he reminds an anonymous woman that if she 'can't rock' him, 'somebody will'. As noted in criticism beginning in the early 1970s, in these songs the Stones denigrate women, celebrate their subordination and objectify them.

In the second half of the 1970s, as violence against women attracted increasing attention, a significant public campaign focused on a Hollywood billboard for the Stones' album *Black and Blue* showing a bound woman and the slogan 'I'm black and blue with the Rolling Stones and I love it'.⁶⁴ In the following years, a number of critics emphasized violence in Rolling Stones songs. For example, 'Midnight Rambler' (1969) describes a violent rapist. The lyrics alternate between the third person 'he's pouncing like a proud black panther', and the first person 'I'll stick my knife right down your throat'. Political scientist John Orman, in a 1984 book, describes this song as a 'tribute to a rapist'.⁶⁵ In a textbook on mass communication from the early 1990s, Deborah Gordon suggests that the rapist and murderer 'is celebrated as a hero'.⁶⁶ In 'Brown Sugar' (1971), the listener is invited with the narrator to view a 'Scarred old slaver know he's dong alright/Hear him whip the women just around midnight.' A Rolling Stones biographer calls this song 'a paean of racist sexism'.⁶⁷

Though criticism of these tendencies in Rolling Stones lyrics has been widespread, a few voices have sought to provide different readings of these songs. The songwriters themselves have responded to criticism either by dismissing the songs, or by blaming their hostility on specific women. In a 1968 interview, Jagger described a number of songs about women as 'all very unthought-out songs'. Three years later, Richards added 'They're just words . . . they can mean a thousand different things to anybody'. By the late 1970s, Jagger offered some historical perspective on the songs from the 1960s: 'Most of those songs are really silly, they're pretty immature . . . going back to my teenage years . . . At the time there was no feminist criticism because there was no such thing'.⁶⁸ On the other hand, in 1995, Jagger explained 'Stupid Girl' by blaming the women in his life at the time: 'I wasn't in a good relationship . . . I had so many girlfriends at that point. None of them seemed to care they weren't pleasing me very much'.⁶⁹ This is consistent with his 1968 comment that the songs reflected 'a few stupid chicks getting on my nerves'. Richards concurs, blaming 'too many dumb chicks'.⁷⁰ Obviously, the attitudes in some of these songs lingered well beyond the 1960s.

Others claim that the Stones' songs were intended to describe or even criticize the subordination of women and violence against them. Richard Merton acknowledges in a 1968 *New Left Review* comment that songs like 'Under My Thumb' are 'about sexual exploitation'. He claims, however, that 'Nakedly proclaimed, inequality is *de facto*

denounced'.⁷¹ Critic Robert Christgau echoes this approach, arguing that Jagger 'doesn't condone the Midnight Rambler [and other characters] ... he just lays them bare'.⁷² In a more recent academic study, Sheila Whiteley asks about depictions of violence: 'were the Stones simply expressing something important about society—how society *is*—or were they offering an alternative way of life?' She concludes by describing 'the Stones performing the role attributed to artists who provide a window on brutality'.⁷³ Michael Powers goes further, arguing that the Stones' depictions of violence (and other aspects of their songs) function as satire: 'Each song creates characters who operate in an insane world'. The violence in 'Midnight Rambler' is 'the epitome of a sick world gone crazy and is an example of the Rolling Stones at their satirical best'.⁷⁴

While Powers' claim overstates the case, the argument that the Stones describe rather than endorse this violence has some merit. In 'Sympathy for the Devil' (1968), a satanic figure celebrates historical calamities, a catalogue that includes the killing of Jesus, religious wars, the assassinations of the Romanovs and Kennedys and Nazi genocide. The song equates the devil with everyman, sharing moral responsibility for these tragedies.⁷⁵ The ubiquitous narrator stands at times as a passive observer 'I was round when ...', but sometimes carries out murders: 'killed the Czar and his ministers ... rode a tank, held a general's rank'. Yet it makes little sense to assert that the Stones advocate genocide or political assassination. Similarly, we should not conclude that references to the Boston Strangler in 'Midnight Rambler' advocate mass murder and rape.⁷⁶

In many Rolling Stones songs, the narrator is clearly *not* the songwriter or singer. In 'Midnight Rambler', the narrator shifts between third and first person, intermittently taking on the character of the Boston Strangler. 'Sympathy for the Devil' is a first-person narrative that spans two millennia. In 'Brown Sugar', the narrator is witness to the African slave trade into New Orleans. Other examples of narrators who are obviously not the songwriter include 'Flight 505' (1966), in which the narrator goes down on a doomed flight, and 'Hand of Fate' (1976). The narrator in the latter has killed a man in a gunfight and expects to be caught imminently. While these songs all depict violence and/or death, the position of the narrator as an eyewitness or a participant in the events invites the audience to view and consider the events without the filter of an omniscient commentator. In some of these songs, the Stones raise moral issues by depicting violence in historical and contemporary events. When the narrator revels in mass murder (as in 'Sympathy for the Devil') or rape ('Midnight Rambler'), he does not speak for the songwriter or singer.

In other Rolling Stones songs, however, the audience can more easily associate the narrator with the Stones themselves. The narrators are young men in situations that could conceivably reflect the songwriters' lives. Devices such as the shift between first- and third-person narration are missing in these instances. In some of these songs, the narrators claim to have been victimized by women. They express either confusion ('Take It or Leave It' or 'Sitting on a Fence', both from 1967) or anger and the desire for revenge ('Turd on the Run' from 1972). In another of the Stones' personas, the

narrator is a sensitive or needy man, proclaiming his love for a woman ('You Got the Silver' from 1969). In the case of both the needy lover and the confused or vengeful 'victim', the space between the narrators and the performers/writers narrows.

It is easier to conceive of these songs as endorsements of attitudes or behaviour. Thus, the determination of the narrator in 'Under My Thumb' to dominate women can plausibly be read as the view (or more accurately a view) of the songwriters. Here, a man celebrates the return of women to an established position of subordination. If it is a stretch to assume that the Stones advocate mass murder, it is far more credible to suggest that (in this song) they endorse the accepted gender roles of post-war British society. As Michael Parsons notes in response to Merton's *New Left Review* comment, in songs such as 'Under My Thumb': 'There does not seem to be any grounds for assuming the Stones themselves . . . adopt a critical attitude' towards the subordination of women.⁷⁷

In the decades since the early critiques of Rolling Stones songs grew out of the emerging women's liberation movement, the academic study of popular culture has led to further analysis of rock songs. Key studies of the Stones have proposed two dichotomies in their songs, between real (and contemptible) women and idealized feminine models, and between mobile men and domesticated homebound women. According to Reynolds and Press, men 'simultaneously worship an abstract femininity . . . while ferociously despising and fearing real-life women'.⁷⁸ A number of Stones songs describe women in fiercely contemptuous terms. 'Stupid Girl', mentioned above, offers a leading example. In some cases, abuse is hurled at women from upper-class backgrounds, as in '19th Nervous Breakdown' (1966).⁷⁹ Here, a rich girl, 'always spoiled with a thousand toys', cannot be redeemed. The song accuses her of having 'turned [her] back on treating people kind', and the narrator gives up on trying to improve her, as she is 'just insane'. 'Play with Fire' (1965) offers another indictment of a rich girl, depicted being driven around by her chauffeur. In this case, the narrator warns her to 'watch your step girl' when dealing with him, as she is 'playing with fire'. In 'Back Street Girl' (1967), on the other hand, the narrator's disdain extends to a woman from a working-class background. She is warned to keep to herself, out of his public life, as she is 'common and coarse anyway' and her 'manners are never quite right'.

Other images depict women as threatening to men. In 'Cool, Calm, Collected' (1966), the rich woman may seem appealing, 'She seems to glow brilliantly white'. Yet this is merely camouflage, hiding 'her teeth ready, sharpened to bite'. The 'Stupid Girl', 'digs for gold' and 'grabs and holds'. In 'Sitting on a Fence', the narrator complains: 'there is one thing I could never understand/Some of the sick things that a girl does to a man'. The woman described in 'Melody' (1976) mistreated the narrator by hiding in his house with another man and disappearing only to be found in the arms of his friend. The last verse laments: 'Then one day she left me/She took everything that moved'. In these songs, women appear as threats to men's money, dignity and well-being.

In Reynolds and Press' dichotomy, then, these portraits refer to real women who are targets of disdain and contempt but are also dangerous. Idealized fairy women offer a

stark contrast. For example, 'Gomper' (1967) describes a mysterious sprite: 'to and fro she's gently gliding/On the glassy lake she's riding'. Whiteley notes, 'the imagined woman floats down in blissful languor on or towards the surface of a pond partly overgrown with lilies'. In 'She's A Rainbow' (1967), the mystical female figure explodes in psychedelic colours, 'She comes in colours everywhere'. Her face is described as a 'speck of white so fair and pale/Have you seen a lady fairer?'. These 'romanticised fantasy figures' offer an 'escape from reality'.⁸⁰

Another ideal type of woman that appears in Rolling Stones songs offers a domestic haven. In 'She Smiled Sweetly' (1967), the narrator faces a stressful existence. Unable to free himself of disturbing thoughts, he is finally calmed by the woman when, 'she smiled sweetly and said don't worry'. A woman in 'A Fool to Cry' (1976) offers similar solace: 'I put my head on her shoulder/She says, "Tell me all your troubles"'. In this case, the woman also provides sexual satisfaction: 'we make love so fine'. A more explicitly sexual take on the idealized domestic haven appears in 'Let It Bleed' (1969). Here a woman promises the narrator, 'my breasts they will always be open/You can lay your weary head right on me'. After suggesting that he can dream, bleed and feed on her, she concludes with 'You can come all over me'.

These domestic images fit into another dichotomy, advanced in recent scholarly work, between domesticated women and men who are mobile and free. For Simon Frith and Angela McRobbie (building on Hiwatt's 1970 article), the Rolling Stones exemplify 'cock rock' celebrating 'the rampant destructive male traveler'.⁸¹ An example of the masculine ideal of freedom appears in the aptly named 'I'm Free' (1965). Here the narrator urges a woman to 'hold me, love me', but insists again and again that he is free to do what he wants, get what he wants, choose what he pleases. In 'If You Really Want To Be My Friend' (1974), a woman is urged, if she wants to understand a man, to 'Let him off the lead sometimes, set him free'. She should 'Let me live it up like I used to do' and 'Get your nails out of my back'. In this song, though, the woman is also offered her freedom, as the narrator insists that he does not want to tie her up or brand her. In one refrain, the narrator switches positions, taking on the voice of a woman who urges: 'If you really want to be my man/Get your nails out of my back/Stop using me'. Reynolds and Press argue, however, that this mutualism is less than convincing, pointing out 'that what sounds and feels like "freedom"—the music of the Rolling Stones, the Stooges, Sex Pistols, for instance—can conceal the seeds of domination'. Whiteley agrees: 'What is obvious, however, is that this commitment to personal freedom was not extended towards women who continued to be inscribed with a chauvinistic frame of reference'.⁸²

Thus, Reynolds and Press, Frith and McRobbie and Whiteley argue that these dichotomies (real vs. imaginary women and mobile men vs. domesticated women) express the Stones' determination to subordinate women. Yet a detailed look at other examples of Stones songs from the same period reveals problems with these distinctions and with established characterizations of women's images in Stones songs. These other examples undermine the sharp dichotomy between realistic and idealized portraits of women. They include descriptions of mobile and free women who are

respected by the narrators. The Stones also produced songs depicting mutual, often complex relationships that reveal the ambivalence with which the Rolling Stones viewed women who challenged established gender roles.

Other Images of Women in Rolling Stones Songs

In a number of songs, the Stones depict these women positively. 'Ruby Tuesday' was recorded in 1966 (and released early in 1967), the same year the Stones made 'Under My Thumb'. Yet its three verses and chorus paint a compelling picture of an independent woman. The overall theme is her freedom and unpredictability. In the first verse, she has left the past behind, 'Yesterday don't matter'. Nobody can predict her behaviour, as she comes and goes whenever she wants to do so. The chorus bids her farewell, apparently after she has departed without warning. It notes her independence from marriage and men, 'Who could hang a name on you?', reasserts her changeability and then offers the narrator's positive view of her, asserting that he will miss her as she pursues her independence and behaves unpredictably. The second verse emphasizes her freedom and refusal to remain trapped in a meaningless existence: 'She just can't be chained to a life where nothing's gained and nothing's lost'. The final verse describes her determination not to lose sight of her dreams: "There's no time to lose," I heard her say, "Catch your dreams before they slip away". This verse has a melancholy tone, as mortality's threat drives her to continue her quest.

'Memory Motel' (1976) mixes nostalgic reverie with reflections on the difficulty of a musician's life on the road. In the first verse, the narrator reveals the source of his nostalgia, a night along the ocean with a woman named Hannah. He then describes her appearance, her hazel eyes and curved nose and teeth. He recalls her playing guitar and singing a song that 'Stuck right in my brain'. The chorus is in two parts, one reflecting that Hannah is just a memory, though she 'used to mean so much to me', and the other asserting her individuality and praising her intelligence and independence: 'She's got a mind of her own and she uses it well'. The next verse reveals parallel descriptions of Hannah and the narrator travelling as musicians. Hannah is driving to Boston in an old pickup truck, while the narrator must fly to Baton Rouge and on to Texas. The final verse focuses on the narrator's further travel through 15 states and his unhappiness, presumably at missing Hannah.

'Star Star' (1973) may seem an odd example to illustrate Rolling Stones lyrics that go beyond subordinating or objectifying women. In four verses plus a chorus, this song pays tribute to a groupie in explicit language. The chorus consists of the repetition of 'star fucker' a dozen times. In the first verse, the narrator expresses his sadness that the woman has gone back to New York City and his hopes to reunite with her there. The second verse reveals her plan to go to Hollywood and notes that friends of the narrator will want to make contact with her and 'Get their tongues beneath your hood'. The third verse enumerates some of her 'tricks' and mentions some notorious Polaroids in her possession, before repeating the narrator's intentions if they get together again. The final verse notes that Ali McGraw was angry because the woman

was 'giving head to Steve McQueen'. It recalls that the 'Starfucker' and the narrator made a good pair and assures her that he is 'open to anything'. The verse concludes with a bet that she would 'get John Wayne'.

A song about a groupie might seem to be a natural vehicle for the misogynistic objectification of women. Yet even though the narrator promises to make her 'scream all night' if they get back together, the 'Starfucker' is the agent of most of the sexual interactions described in the song. Oral sex is described twice in the song; in one instance the woman performs it and in the other she receives it. She controls her contact with the narrator, abandoning him even though it leaves him saddened and asking her to call him. Often the male 'gaze', identification with the voyeur, forms an essential strategy in the objectification of women.⁸³ In 'Star Star', however, the woman appropriates the gaze. She possesses the Polaroids. She also pursues and possesses men, reversing the typical objectifying pattern of women as prey. This woman is likely, we are assured, to 'get John Wayne'. She is neither a passive victim nor a possession of men, to be taken and discarded. She pursues men, captures them as Polaroid trophies and leaves them when she is ready, headed for new conquests in New York or Hollywood. The form of women's empowerment here is a limited one, envisioned through the lens of sexually permissive youth culture, but it remains a vision of an independent woman.

These three examples defy the expectations of Rolling Stones songs based on the analyses described above. None of these women is subordinated to men, 'under their thumbs'. They do as they please and the narrators approve. With the exception of the ambiguous 'scream all night' reference in 'Star Star', none are victims of violence. Neither Ruby nor Hannah is valued principally as a vehicle for male sexual pleasure. 'Ruby Tuesday' does not mention sex at all. 'Memory Motel' refers to a night spent together, but it does not focus on the sex. Instead, the most vivid images of Hannah involve her playing a song for the narrator and his reflections on her intelligence and independent mind. 'Star Star' is, of course, about sex. Yet even though it is about a groupie (and repeats the 'Starfucker' refrain again and again), it presents a more complex picture than woman as sexual conquest or object for male pleasure.⁸⁴

The women in these songs do not fit the dichotomy between mobile, free men and domesticated women. The groupie in 'Star Star' is not tied down; she moves on, to New York City and to Hollywood, leaving the narrator to wonder if they will ever get back together. Hannah in 'Memory Motel' also moves freely. A battered pickup truck and its weathered tires symbolize her mobility. She heads north to Boston, while the narrator flies south. Similarly, mobility forms one of the key themes of 'Ruby Tuesday'. She comes and goes unpredictably, chasing her dreams and refusing to be chained. Though Whiteley argues that the desire for freedom at the heart of the period's youth culture did not apply to women, Ruby appropriates many of the fundamental attitudes of this culture.⁸⁵ Determined to escape the insanity of a meaningless existence, she lives for the moment, does her own thing and follows her dreams. All these images subvert the freedom/domesticity dichotomy.

The other dichotomy discussed above, between negative portrayals of real women and positive images only of idealized mystical figures or domestic nurses, also breaks

down in the light of these examples. Stones songs offer positive portrayals of a wide range of women. These do include domestic havens and mystical sprites as well as willing and available sexual partners. They also include 'Ruby Tuesday', the independent seeker of happiness, and Hannah, the travelling musician and independent thinker. Whiteley suggests that songs of this period failed to give 'serious thought to the individuality or, indeed, the diversity of women'.⁸⁶ Yet these positive images of women are diverse, and some of them do celebrate these women as individuals. Reynolds and Press criticize the 'mawkish idealism' of 'Ruby Tuesday', enumerating it as typical of depictions of 'elusive, mystical sprites'.⁸⁷ Ruby's existential reflections on mortality argue against this interpretation. For her, death is not a mystical opening of a new door. Rather, she hastens from the narrator to follow her dreams because of the impending threat of death. Facing the reality that we are 'Dying all the time', Ruby is in a hurry. On the other hand, negative portrayals of women in Rolling Stones songs are often archetypes. For example, '19th Nervous Breakdown' ridicules the stereotypic spoiled rich girl. Images of women in Rolling Stones songs do not neatly fit the real vs. imaginary dichotomy drawn by these critics.

Other nuanced pictures of women (and men) appear in Rolling Stones songs about relationships. Frith and McRobbie dismiss 'Angie' (1973) as an example of 'suitably soppy songs with which to celebrate true (lustless) love'. This sort of song carries 'messages of male self-doubt and self-pity', which complement expressions of a 'deep fear of women'.⁸⁸ Yet 'Angie' offers a complex depiction of a relationship under strain. The narrator combines regret at both partners' dissatisfaction and the collapse of shared dreams, 'all the dreams we held so close seemed to all go up in smoke', with a persistent fondness for the woman: 'I still love you'. He advocates ending the relationship because it does not work, not because the woman is evil, insubordinate or threatening. Perhaps the narrator's desire to end the relationship is driven by self-pity, but it is framed in terms of mutual frustrations and a shared effort to make the relationship work: 'you can't say we never tried'.

This shared responsibility for a failed relationship also appears in 'We're Wasting Time' (released in 1975, though recorded years earlier). The narrator laments the fate of a couple who cannot escape memories of past lovers. At the start of the song, the narrator is preoccupied by these thoughts: 'Inside my mind/The thought of her won't go away'. The relationship cannot succeed, and thus the two are wasting time. As the song moves forward, though, the focus shifts to the woman, who has the same problem: 'inside your mind/The thought of him won't go away'. This repetition highlights the shared dilemma. Neither the man nor the woman is the villain here. Both carry these memories with them, and their relationship fails because of both their difficulties.

A difficult relationship appears to have more promise in 'Wild Horses' (1971). Its narrator pledges not to give up on a troubled relationship, characterized by suffering by both parties. The pain is mutual: 'I've watched you suffer . . . Now you decided to show me the same'. The narrator expresses his dedication to the woman, bringing her gifts and pledging to stick by her. He renounces freedom in favour of this devotion.

Mortality hovers over this song as well, as the narrator suggests that they 'do some living' together before their deaths, noting that his time is short. This is not an idealized woman or relationship. Although 'Faith has been broken, tears must be cried', he puts aside bitterness. The use of the passive voice leaves it unclear who has broken faith. Rather than demonize the woman based on her flaws (as other songs do), this narrator accepts his partner on the basis of equality, embracing the relationship despite its difficulties and refusing to let the woman 'slide through my hands'. Both 'Angie' and 'Wild Horses' are soft, slow songs in which the singer adopts the persona of a sensitive and loving man that contrasts sharply with the exaggerated macho character of songs like 'If You Can't Rock Me'.

In many other songs, the Stones' depictions of women and relationships do not include objectification and hostility. While some songs consider women chiefly as objects of men's desire and means of pleasure for male narrators, others conceive of sex as mutual. 'Let's Spend the Night Together' (1967) pledges, 'I'll satisfy your every need'. It then suggests confidently, 'I know you will satisfy me'. In 'Loving Cup' (1972) the narrator declares his desire to 'spill the beans with you till dawn', announcing that he feels 'humble with you tonight/Just sitting in front of the fire'. This cosy, romantic scene is compared to a drug: 'What a beautiful buzz'.

Other songs are not primarily concerned with women or relationships, but they mention women as partners of men. Once again, this contrasts with the angry demonization of and determination to subordinate women in other Stones songs. The narrator of 'Jig-Saw Puzzle' (1968) surveys a series of puzzling and perverse vignettes, including a surreal charge of soldiers led by the queen who attack protesting old women. The narrator adopts a position outside this chaos, patiently trying to construct his puzzle 'before it rains anymore'. In the final verse, we learn that the narrator is not alone; a woman is sitting on the floor with him, helping to figure out the puzzle: 'We're just trying to do this jig-saw puzzle/Before it rains anymore'. 'Monkey Man' (1969) presents an inversion of 'Jig-Saw Puzzle' that, however, also asserts a partnership between the narrator and a woman. Using a term familiar in American blues, this narrator's status as a 'monkey man' puts him outside the mainstream.⁸⁹ While in 'Jig-Saw Puzzle' the narrator (and the woman next to him) appear sane while observing a bizarre society, in this case it is the narrator who is odd. The 'monkey man' trumpets his abnormality, his chaotic life and his victimization. The woman to whom the song is addressed appears, once again, as the narrator's partner in marginality: 'I am just a monkey man/I'm glad you are a monkey woman, too'. The narrator in each of these songs adopts a position on the fringes of society, but in each case he is accompanied by a like-minded woman, helping him figure out the puzzle or sharing his eccentricities. 'Jig-Saw Puzzle' offers an interesting contrast with 'Sittin' on a Fence', in which the narrator also surveys a disturbing scene, this time of unhappy men settled in marriage. In this case, women are the villains, and the confusion originates in 'the sick things a girl does to a man'. As these examples show, the Rolling Stones both advocated embracing women as their partners in the new youth culture and demonized them as threats to male authority.

Conclusion

In the 1960s, as the Rolling Stones reached adulthood and launched their career, some young women sought new opportunities through education, work and even sexual freedom. These women cast aside societal conventions in favour of independence and freedom. Though they remained in the minority in the 1960s, the new women tended to congregate in London, and their images pervaded the culture. Rowbotham notes that young men's responses were complex: 'I sensed something very complicated going on in the heads of men who were about my age'. She observes: 'Young men had, after all, not been prepared by their 1950s upbringings for the new Quant-style woman'. In trying to understand men's responses, Rowbotham suggests that popular music is the most useful resource, writing in 1973 that, 'The most eloquent records (of men's responses) exist in the songs we've been listening to since the sixties'.⁹⁰ She ties this phenomenon explicitly to the Rolling Stones, whose 'songs are really often very scared. It's as if they sense a threat to the old way of being a man'.⁹¹ A contemporary of hers recalls, 'a lot of men have been affected by having to face up to changes in their women, and a lot of them weren't able to'.⁹²

As they built a movement for women's liberation, some women highlighted the Rolling Stones as prime advocates of the subordination and objectification of women. Later scholars have agreed. To an extent, this is a point well taken. 'Under My Thumb' is an unambiguous rejection of women's autonomy. The Stones saw women trying to escape subordination and tried to plant them firmly under male control. 'If You Can't Rock Me' welcomes sexual freedom, but only as a vehicle for the fulfilment of men's sexual desires. 'Let it Bleed' celebrates women's role as havens to which more mobile and free men can return for comfort and sex. What has not generally been recognized, however, is that the Rolling Stones also offered quite different images of women. Songs such as 'Memory Motel' and 'Ruby Tuesday' praise free, mobile women who reject dependence on and subordination to men. These women demand autonomy, follow their dreams and have sex on their own terms. Other songs offer models of complex, mutual relationships through which men and women struggle to find happiness or understanding. The Rolling Stones' songs reveal an ambivalent response to new claims made by women in the 1960s. On the one hand, they seek to control women. On the other, they appreciate women who embrace autonomy. 'Under My Thumb' and 'Ruby Tuesday', produced within months of one another in 1966, exemplify the deep contradictions in the Rolling Stones' music between the desire to subordinate women and the embrace of a new kind of independent woman.

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Notes

- [1] Rowbotham, *Promise of a Dream*, 5.
- [2] Heron, *Truth, Dare or Promise*, 207.
- [3] Rowbotham, *Promise of a Dream*, 115, 229, 250–2; *Woman's Consciousness*, 24.
- [4] Rowbotham, *Woman's Consciousness*, 14, 13, 22.
- [5] Donnelly, *Sixties Britain*, 35.
- [6] Whiteley, *Women and Popular Music*, 23.
- [7] Bailey, 'Conspiracies of Meaning', 142; Whiteley, 'Little Red Rooster', 67, 76.
- [8] Frith, 'Why Do Songs Have Words', 101. Italics in original.
- [9] Osgerby, *Youth in Britain*, 51–2.
- [10] Maclure, 'Forty Years On', 127–8.
- [11] Osgerby, *Youth in Britain*, 86–8.
- [12] Weeks, *Sex, Politics and Society*, 258; Cook, *Long Sexual Revolution*, 268–9; Collins, 'Pornography of Permissiveness', 102.
- [13] Ingham, *Now We are Thirty*, 166–7, 178.
- [14] *Ibid.*, 137.
- [15] Lewis, *Women in Britain*, 44, 48.
- [16] Dunn, *Talking to Women*, 18, 136.
- [17] Maitland, *Very Heaven*, 15.
- [18] Green, *All Dressed Up*, 86.
- [19] Donnelly, *Sixties Britain*, xiii.
- [20] Collins, *Modern Love*, 175.
- [21] Osgerby, *Youth in Britain*, 53.
- [22] Levy, *Ready, Steady, Go*, 47.
- [23] Rowbotham, *Century of Women*, 351, 364.
- [24] Levy, *Ready, Steady, Go*, 312.
- [25] Crane, 'Fashion Design', 66; Quant, *Quant*, 75.
- [26] Maitland, *Very Heaven*, 170–1.
- [27] Tarr, 'Boundaries of Permitted Pleasure', 59, 61; Geraghty, 'Women and Sixties British Cinema', 104–5.
- [28] Faithfull, *Faithfull*, 86.
- [29] Levy, *Ready, Steady, Go*, 181.
- [30] Balfour, *Rock Wives*, 117–8.
- [31] Faithfull, *Faithfull*, 138, 153.
- [32] Davis, *Old Gods Almost Dead*, 155.
- [33] Moller, *Technicolor Dreamin'*, 226; Collins, *Modern Love*, 175–6.
- [34] Meehan, 'British Feminism', 193–4.
- [35] Mitchell, 'Women: The Longest Revolution', 25.
- [36] Rowbotham, 'Women's Liberation and the New Politics'; Segal, *Straight Sex*, 28.
- [37] Spongberg, 'Germaine Greer', 416; Ellis, 'Black and Blue from the Rolling Stones', 434.
- [38] Densmore, 'Independence', 111.
- [39] Wyman, *Stone Alone*, 203.
- [40] Donnelly, *Sixties Britain*, 46.
- [41] Frith and McRobbie, 'Rock and Sexuality', 372.
- [42] Whiteley, *Space between the Notes*, 89.
- [43] Reynolds and Press, *Sex Revolts*, 19.
- [44] Norman, *Symphony for the Devil*, 117–8, 141–2, 163–4, 177; Levy, *Ready, Steady, Go*, 159.
- [45] Haynes, *Thanks for Coming*, 277.
- [46] Davis, *Old Gods Almost Dead*, 231–2; Green, *All Dressed Up*, 262.
- [47] Levy, *Ready, Steady, Go*, 176.

- [48] Greer, *Madwoman's Underclothes*, 19.
- [49] Segal, *Straight Sex*, 8.
- [50] Kubernik, *This is Rebel Music*, 144.
- [51] *IT* 100 (25 March–8 April 1971), 20.
- [52] Green, *All Dressed Up*, 82, 180.
- [53] Norman, *Symphony for the Devil*, 222–3.
- [54] Frith, 'Why Do Songs Have Words', 91.
- [55] Wells, 'Me and the Devil Blues', 19.
- [56] Norman, *Symphony for the Devil*, 348, 369.
- [57] Whiteley, 'Little Red Rooster', 93.
- [58] Meade, Marion. 'Does Rock Degrade Women?' *New York Times*, 14 March 1971, D13, D22.
- [59] Reynolds and Press, *Sex Revolts*, 19.
- [60] Pedigo, 'Under My Thumb', 12.
- [61] Hiwatt, 'Cock Rock', 144.
- [62] Wyman, *Stone Alone*, 375; Thompson, 'Before and After "Aftermath"', 18.
- [63] Pedigo, 'Under My Thumb', 26.
- [64] Ellis, 'I'm Black and Blue', 431; Whiteley, 'Little Red Rooster', 73.
- [65] Orman, *Politics of Rock Music*, 99.
- [66] Gordon, 'Image of Women', 166.
- [67] Norman, *Symphony for the Devil*, 351.
- [68] *Rolling Stone* Editors, *Rolling Stone Interviews*, 48, 170, 331–2.
- [69] Wenner, 'Jagger Remembers'.
- [70] *Rolling Stone* Editors, *Rolling Stone Interviews*, 48, 171.
- [71] Merton, 'Comment', 30.
- [72] Christgau, 'Rolling Stones', 199.
- [73] Whiteley, *Space between the Notes*, 88, 102.
- [74] Powers, 'Rolling Stones', 47, 49.
- [75] Orman, *Politics of Rock Music*, 101.
- [76] Gracyk, *I Wanna Be Me*, 191.
- [77] Parsons, 'Rolling Stones', 118.
- [78] Reynolds and Press, *Sex Revolts*, 3.
- [79] Nehring, *Flowers in the Dustbin*, 251–2.
- [80] Whiteley, *Women and Popular Music*, 23, 36; Whiteley, 'Repressive Representations', 163.
- [81] Frith and McRobbie, 'Rock and Sexuality', 374.
- [82] Reynolds and Press, *Sex Revolts*, xv; Whiteley, *Women and Popular Music*, 37.
- [83] Whiteley, *Women and Popular Music*, 37.
- [84] Kerr Fenn, 'Daughters of the Revolution', 168.
- [85] Whiteley, *Women and Popular Music*, 37.
- [86] *Ibid.*, 40.
- [87] Reynolds and Press, *Sex Revolts*, 21.
- [88] Frith and McRobbie, 'Rock and Sexuality', 382.
- [89] Hellman, 'Influence of the Black American Blues', 373.
- [90] Rowbotham, *Woman's Consciousness*, 21–2.
- [91] *Ibid.*, Rowbotham, *A Century of Women*, 364.
- [92] Wandor, *Once a Feminist*, 120.

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